

Japanese Basics

First words and sentences · Equigrow short notes

Script

Three scripts: **hiragana** (native words, grammar), **katakana** (foreign words) and **kanji** (Chinese characters). Learn hiragana first (46 basic characters), then katakana. The notes below are romanised.

Greetings & phrases

Phrase	Meaning
Konnichiwa	Hello
Watashi wa ... desu	I am ...
Arigatou (gozaimasu)	Thank you (polite)
Sumimasen	Excuse me / Sorry
Sayounara	Goodbye

Numbers 1-10

ichi, ni, san, yon (shi), go, roku, nana (shichi), hachi, kyuu, juu

Getting started

- Word order is subject – object – verb: Watashi wa nihongo o benkyou shimasu (I study Japanese).
- Particles mark roles: wa (topic), o (object), ni (to/at).
- JLPT levels go from N5 (beginner) to N1.